

What Are You Proving? — Proof Statement Report (FL-01)

Author: Gautam Kumar | Workspace: small-backend/proving | Track: AI Fluency Week 01 | Date: July 2026

1. The One-Paragraph Proof Statement (Claim + Person + Action)

"I can build secure, production-ready backend APIs for third-party widget integrations. This proof is built specifically for a Senior Engineering Manager or Lead Backend Architect at a B2B SaaS startup who is hiring a junior backend engineer to own customer-facing integrations and data-capture endpoints. By examining my small-backend architecture—specifically how I engineered cross-origin resource sharing (CORS) preflight handshakes, in-memory rate limiting, and webhook lead submissions for an embeddable customer widget—the single most important action I want them to take is to book a 15-minute technical interview call to inspect my live API endpoints and codebase."

2. The One-Line Honest 'Why' (What This Fixes)

"A CV or LinkedIn profile can list 'Node.js' and 'REST APIs' as bullet points, but it cannot prove to an engineering manager that I know how to handle real-world browser security, CORS preflight handshakes, and rate-limited cross-origin requests without breaking production."

3. Socratic AI Interview Log (How I Owned & Narrowed the Claim)

Round 1 (Stripping the 'And' Trap): My initial draft claimed full-stack design, frontend, backend, and DevOps. The AI challenged that claiming everything convinces no one. I pushed back and narrowed the claim to the hardest problem I solved: **secure cross-origin widget communication on port 3000 from an external site on port 3001**.

Round 2 (Narrowing the Audience): The AI challenged who actually reads backend middleware code. I discarded generic recruiters and targeted the **Senior Engineering Manager / Lead Backend Architect** at a B2B SaaS startup who evaluates architectural safety.

Round 3 (Defining the Action & Proof Anchor): I selected **booking a 15-minute technical interview call** as the primary action. This statement can only describe my small-backend project because it anchors explicitly on CORS OPTIONS preflight handshakes and rate-limiting middleware.

4. Technical Mapping to small-backend Codebase & Verification Table

```
small-backend/Script/
■■■ public/customer-site.html --> Third-party embed script host (localhost:3001)
■■■ public/cdn/widget.js --> Async embeddable widget loader
■■■ src/middleware/cors.middleware.js --> HTTP OPTIONS preflight & origin whitelisting
■■■ src/middleware/rateLimit.js --> In-memory sliding window rate limiting (RFC 6585)
■■■ src/routes/public.routes.js --> POST /widgets/:id/submissions endpoint
```

Evaluation Criterion	Status	Evidence in This Deliverable
1. Primary claim is named	PASS	"I can build secure, production-ready backend APIs for third-party widget integrations." (No laundry list of skills).
2. Audience is a specific person	PASS	Targeted at a Senior Engineering Manager or Lead Backend Architect at a B2B SaaS startup .
3. Single primary action	PASS	Action: " Book a 15-minute technical interview call to inspect my live API endpoints and codebase. "
4. Unique to this project	PASS	Anchored explicitly on CORS preflight handshakes, embed scripts, and rate-limited endpoints in `small-backend`.
5. Honest one-line 'Why'	PASS	Explains why CV bullet points fail to prove real-world browser security and cross-origin integration competence.